

8.1 Know your audience ↕

□ Activity: Big tech, big fines

Review the infographic on this webpage. As you read the information and review the visualisation, take time to consider and make notes on:

- how this visualisation could be used to influence organisations/individuals
- what message(s) this visualisation conveys
- what is good about the visualisation and what is not as good.

Explain your reasoning and bring your notes to the workshop.

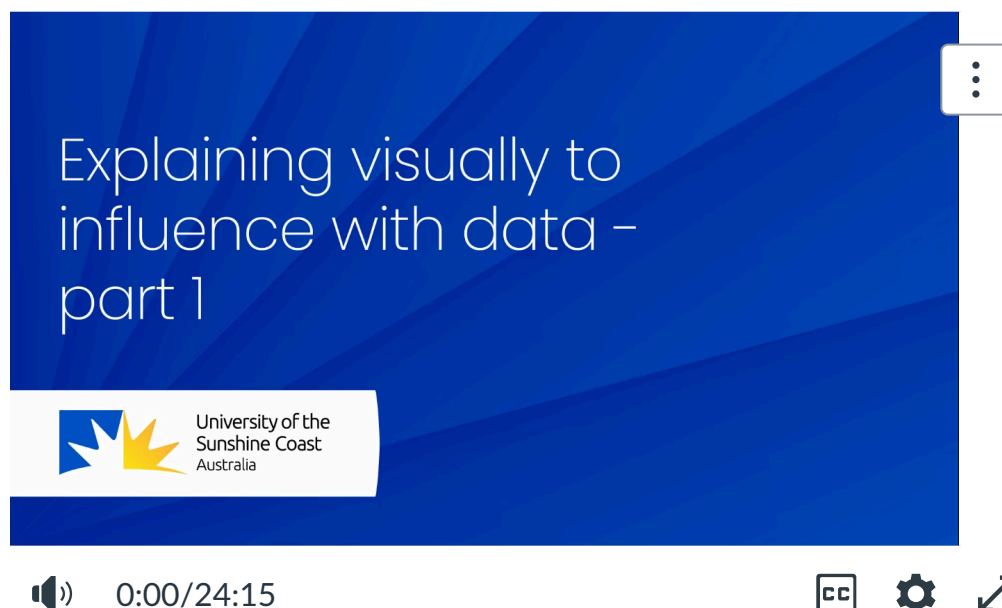
Zandt, F. (2023, May 23). [Big tech, big fines](https://www.statista.com/chart/25691/highest-fines-for-gdpr-breaches/) ↗

(<https://www.statista.com/chart/25691/highest-fines-for-gdpr-breaches/>). Statista.

□ Watch: Explaining visually to influence with data (part 1) [24:15 mins]

Watch the following video, which explains the importance of knowing the needs and an analytical comfort level of an audience. It also provides a matrix, which details the types of visualisations which are appropriate for the needs of varying audiences.

This is useful as it provides a foundational understanding of the importance of taking audience needs into consideration.



Transcript

(<https://learn.usc.edu.au/courses/35242/files/3138684?wrap=1>)

Source: © University of the Sunshine Coast (2023).

Download the following slides for note taking: [ICT702 Explaining visually to influence with data \(part 1\)](https://learn.usc.edu.au/courses/35242/files/3167506?wrap=1) (<https://learn.usc.edu.au/courses/35242/files/3167506?wrap=1>)

The effectiveness of a presentation may vary from one audience to another. This is because different audiences have differing interests, organisational roles and levels of comfort with analytical methods. As a result, it is very important that you know your audience. It is particularly important to understand:

- what the audience need from the visualisation/presentation
- their level of analytical comfort.

Audience member needs

Understanding an audience's need can help to inform which type of “story” will most effectively convey insights from the data. In other words, certain types of visualisations may be more effective for certain types of audience.

The needs of an audience can be classified as:

- *high-level understanding*. It is often best to use simple charts that communicate the main insight.
- *detailed understanding*. It is best to use more sophisticated visualisations, enabling the audience to understand greater detail, which in turn may promote further discussion.

Audience member analytical comfort levels

Understanding the audience's analytical comfort level is equally important. They can have:

- *low comfort with analytics*. If an audience does not have much experience with interpreting more sophisticated data visualisations, they may find that type of visualisation confusing and cognitively demanding. In such instances, it is better to use simple charts that highlight the main, or a single, insight. These charts should be easily explained, making the cognitive load on the audience low.
- *higher comfort with analytics*. For audiences that have more experience with sophisticated data visualisations, it is likely to be more useful to use charts that provide additional details and insights.

□ Watch: Knowing your audience [4.41 mins]

The following video is about public speaking and about knowing the audience you are going to be speaking/presenting to. The concepts relate to well presenting information in most contexts, and the video is useful as it provides advice about addressing an audience.

As you watch, consider:

- How can this knowledge be applied to designing data visualisations and presenting them to an audience?
- Why is it important to know your audience?



Source: © Toastmasters International (2012).

□ Activity: Choosing the best chart type for your audience

In the activity below, drag and drop each chart type into the correct quadrant:

*Here's a hint, a **scatter chart** would fall into the quadrant where **detailed insights are needed**, along with **high analytical comfort** (bottom right).*

Low analytical comfort

High analytical comfort

**Only high-level insights
needed**

Detailed insights needed

Simple bar/column charts

✓ Submit

Source: Adapted from Camm et al. (2021, p. 292).